

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's important to keep in contact.



Learning Outcome

Explain customs and appropriate behavior at work and in different countries, using a wider range of expressions and formulas.

Can Do Statements

- I can speculate about a situation.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk about my attitudes toward an action.

Ask your partner:

- How do you normally get in contact with people?
- How often do you have difficulties contacting someone?
- What do you do when you can't get in contact?





Let's Explore!

Ferdinand may have a **bad connection**.*

* A "bad connection" is when you can't communicate well because of technology problems.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Secretary:** Miss Ellison, something must be happening to Ferdinand. It could be a bad connection.
- Janet:** Has he tried contacting me more than once? Wait, he might not have access to Wi-Fi.
- Secretary:** There's this one voice message. But he kept on calling from his cell phone. Allow me to replay it.
- Answering machine:** *"Janet, I apologize for being absent, but we really need to chat. Pretty serious matter. It could jeopardize everything ..."*
- Secretary:** Sounds like there might be an emergency vehicle and then it cuts out.
- Janet:** It could be an ambulance. An accident? He may be hurt.
- Miranda:** I've know him for a while. He tends to avoid getting in trouble. He should be fine.
- Janet:** Could this be related to the event?
- Miranda:** It can't be. I'd be surprised since things came off really well. What may have changed? You've tried calling, right?
- Janet:** Yes, repeatedly. I can't stand calling him and reaching his voicemail. It's full and I can't leave a message. I wonder if he could be experiencing financial difficulties.
- Miranda:** It can't be that. He proposed not making any financial negotiations during that time. Could we possibly have a disgruntled competitor?
- Janet:** That is a possibility.
- Miranda:** Janet ... ummm ... I would hesitate to contact Farmani until we hear from Ferdinand.
- Janet:** Absolutely not. Anyway, I urge you to spend the morning trying to contact him.
- Miranda:** I plan on doing that. And ... ummm ... Janet, Ferdinand has good work ethics, I'm sure everything is under control. I'll keep calling!



Let's Practice!

Janet and Miranda wonder* what could** have happened to Ferdinand.

* To "wonder" means to think about and ask questions about something.

** "Could" is a modal you use when talking about a possibility.

Instructions: Match the beginning (Column A) and the end (Column B) of each sentence to complete them correctly. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

COLUMN B

- | | |
|-------------------------------|--|
| 1. Something must be | a. not have access to wi-fi. |
| 2. It can't | b. changed? |
| 3. It could be | c. a bad connection. |
| 4. He might | d. happening to Ferdinand. |
| 5. Sounds like there might be | e. be that. |
| 6. He | f. an emergency vehicle and the it cuts out. |
| 7. What may have | g. may be hurt. |
| 8. Could we | h. possibly have a disgruntled competitor? |



Let's Practice!

Janet and Miranda need to get in touch with* Ferdinand!

* "To get in touch with" someone means to contact them.

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

competitor / disgruntled / jeopardize / financial difficulties / came off

1. It could _____ everything.
2. We need to know what our _____ is doing.
3. Could we possibly have a _____ competitor?
4. I wonder if he could be experiencing _____.
5. I'd be surprised since things _____ really well at the event.





Extension Activity

Make some guesses and assumptions.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write down three situations that need an explanation. (for example, John isn't at work today).
- With a partner, write 5 sentences that make guesses or assumptions about the situation.
- With your partner, decide which of your guesses are the most believable.
- Share your guesses with another group of students.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I speculate about a situation.

☐ ☐

I write guesses and assumptions about a situation.

☐ ☐

I make decisions about guesses.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to jeopardize** (verb): to put into danger
e.g. It could jeopardize everything.
- **serious matter** (noun): a situation or subject that is being dealt with or considered carefully
e.g. This is a pretty serious matter.
- **financial difficulties** (noun): a problem related to finances or money
e.g. I wonder if he could be experiencing financial difficulties.
- **disgruntled** (adjective): unhappy, annoyed, and disappointed about something
e.g. Could we possibly have a disgruntled competitor?
- **come off** (phrasal verb): to happen as planned, or to succeed
e.g. Things came off really well.
- **competitor** (noun): a person, team, or company that is competing against others
e.g. We need to know what our competitor is doing.





Learning Points

Modal Verbs for Speculating and Talking about Possibility

When you speculate about something, you are making an assumption based on what you know about the situation.

You can show you are speculating about something by using a modal, like *must* or *have got* to.

You can also speculate using *can't* and *couldn't*.

For example: John is always online. He **must** not have access to Wi-Fi.

We know something about John so we can make an assumption about why he is not online.

An **assumption** is an "educated guess". You make an assumption when you already have some information about the situation.

To talk about something that is possible you use *might*, *may* and *could*.

For example: We should call his mobile phone. There **may** be a problem with the Wi-Fi.

We don't know about the Wi-Fi so we have to talk about what is possible, or make a guess.

The modal verb is followed by the main verb in the base form. You do not use "to". Do not add "ing", "ed", or "s" to the verb.

Those are formal structures.

Examples:

- *Something must be happening to Ferdinand.*
- *It can't be that.*
- *It could be a bad connection.*
- *He might not have access to Wi-Fi.*
- *Could we possibly have a disgruntled competitor?*

Gerunds and Infinitives

A **gerund** is a verb ending with -ing (doing).

An **infinitive** is to + verb (to do).

There are rules about which verbs you can use with gerunds and which verbs you can use with infinitives.

These structures give more information about how you feel about an action.

Verbs commonly followed by a gerund commonly express **likes/dislikes**:

like





Learning Points

love
enjoy
dislike
hate
can't stand

Example:

*I **can't stand calling** him and reaching his voicemail.*

NOTE: like/love can also be followed by an infinitive.

Some other verbs that are followed by a gerund:

anticipate
consider
delay
complete
involve
suggest
risk
try
avoid
keep

These are some verbs that are followed by an infinitive:

allow
hope
proceed
seem
need
happen
urge

Example:

*I **urge** you **to spend** the morning trying to contact him.*

Examples:

- *He kept on calling from his cell phone.*
- *Allow me to replay it.*
- *I apologize for being absent.*
- *He tends to avoid getting in trouble.*
- *He proposed not making any financial negotiations during that time.*

